

ating system which uses MeeGo and LiMo as its base. And last but not the least the Ubuntu Touch OS, from Canonical with a brilliant new take on mobile operating systems.

App Ecosystems

The most important aspect of any mobile operating systems success is the health and robustness of its app ecosystems. The amount of third-party apps available to the user have played a very important part in deciding the fates of many a platforms, Apple and Google's success in a large measure can be attributed to their excellent app ecosystem powered by Google Play and iTunes. We'll be discussing the four major digital distribution platforms for all the major operating systems that we discussed earlier: Google Play for Android, App Store for iOS, BlackBerry World for BlackBerry and the Windows Phone Store for Windows Phone.

According to Canalys, the app downloads for all the four stores combined, reached a total of 13.4 billion in the first quarter of 2013. Without considering revenue sharing these stores combined raked in a whopping \$2.2 billion. Apple's App Store has taken the lead as far as revenue is concerned, with the largest proportion of revenue at around 74%. Google Play on the other hand saw the largest amount of downloads with it accounting for nearly 51% of the collective downloads total. Windows Phone Store and BlackBerry World are distant challengers to these two heavyweights and will require a lot of effort to entice developers and add innovative content and services to their application catalog.

Google Play

Originally known as Android Marketplace, it was rebranded as Google Play so that it better aligns with Google's take on digital distribution for music, movies & tv shows, magazine and books in addition to Android applications. It currently has the largest catalog of apps on the planet with about 8,50,000 apps and about 48 billion app downloads till May 2013. One thing to note is that the Google Play application is not open source, only the devices that comply with Google's compatibility requirements may install and access this application.

Another thing to note is that the user is not limited to Play Store alone to get the apps, they can be downloaded from the developer's website or even another android application store. Google Play store is often derided for the lack of quality of applications in the app store and there are often